



Aircraft noise over Brockenhurst

A residents' case pack on Bournemouth Airport arrivals, built entirely from the aircraft's own public flight data, 2023 to 2025. Not affiliated with the airport.

THE PROBLEM

The situation is already unbearable for many.

A recent spot survey drew over **255 responses in two days**, and more than **75% of residents** are concerned about the rising number of flights over Brockenhurst and the noise they bring.

Many residents can no longer fully enjoy their homes and gardens. Conversations are interrupted indoors and out as aircraft pass over, and families are regularly woken by late-night flights. The impact reaches beyond residents, to tourists and campers and the wider tranquillity of the New Forest National Park.

Brockenhurst sits **just under 10 nautical miles out, directly in line with the main runway**. It is made worse by aircraft arriving lower than the airport's own published rules, and often turning and levelling off right over the village, which needs extra engine power and extra noise. The numbers rise every year, and it is getting worse at night.

75%

of residents concerned, from a poll of 270 people

77%

of arrivals cross the village below the quiet-descent height

+65%

more large jets in just three years (2023 to 2025)

THREE SIMPLE IDEAS, NO AVIATION KNOWLEDGE NEEDED



A quiet approach is a gentle glide

The most efficient landing is one smooth glide with the engines close to idle. It keeps the plane higher for longer, and quieter.



Turning and levelling off is the loud bit

When a plane stops gliding, turns and flies level, it must add engine power and drag. That surge is the noise you hear overhead.



We sit right in the firing line

Brockenhurst is 9.7 nautical miles in a straight line off the runway, and over 75% of arrivals pass directly overhead.

WHAT WE CAN DO

Can we do anything about this? Yes, and the time is now.

Bournemouth Airport is redrawing its flight paths right now, through the formal CAA process (Airspace Change ACP-2019-43). The new satellite-guided routes are hyper precise: instead of today's scattered flights, aircraft will follow the exact same line. If that line is drawn over Brockenhurst as it is today, it becomes a permanent, concentrated noise highway. That is the threat, and it is also the opportunity to move it.



The law is on our side. The airport has a Section 106 planning commitment to continuous descent approaches, and a duty under the Levelling Up and Regeneration Act 2023 to further the National Park's purposes, the Sandford Principle, which puts conservation first.

WHAT WE NEED

Three changes that would make a real difference.

1

Stick to continuous descent

Hold every arrival to a smooth, engine-idle glide, no early descents and no levelling off over the village. It is already in the airport's own rulebook.

2

Raise the height over Brockenhurst

Fly the standard 3-degree descent, or steeper, so aircraft are meaningfully higher and quieter as they cross the village.

3

Route the new paths around us

As the satellite routes are drawn, place the line to avoid Brockenhurst, without shifting the burden onto other communities.

HOW YOU CAN GET INVOLVED

Your voice genuinely counts.

In the past, Brockenhurst residents did not take part in the consultation, and the flights came our way. This time can be different.



Understand and share

Read this pack, then tell your neighbours what is happening and why the coming consultation matters.



Join the campaign

Get on the Aircraft Noise WhatsApp group. Email aircraft@yourbrockenhurst.org



Complain when disturbed

Every complaint is logged. Email environment@bournemouthairport.com, or use our one-tap complaint card.